TA studio brief — Planning a gallery or exhibition inquiry

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How do we design a structured visual inquiry plan to analyse artworks in an exhibition space?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide stiff A3 clipboards and preview cards of the curated artwork collection so pupils can calibrate their 5-minute shorthand sketching style.

Studio kit: A3 Gallery inquiry templates, curated exhibition pack previews, 2B/4B graphite, fineliners, viewfinders, clipboards

Key words to prompt

• inquiry framework: A structured set of visual lenses and sketching zones prepared before visiting or studying an exhibition.

• spatial layout: How artworks are positioned in relation to walls, plinths, lighting, and viewer pathways.

• execution: The technical skill and material control shown in how an artwork is physically made.

• juxtaposition: Placing two contrasting works or materials near each other to spark visual dialogue.

• critical question: An open analytical question that investigates how a work achieves its visual impact.

Supported route steps

1. Label the four recording zones on your Gallery inquiry sheet.

2. Select and tick three critical inquiry questions from the studio prompt bank.

3. Complete a 4-minute pilot tonal sketch of the preview artwork in the practice corner box.

4. Clip your prepared sheet and pencil kit onto your field clipboard for Week 6.

Check: Four inquiry zones set up, three questions selected, and pilot sketch completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: Why do we prepare structured recording zones and critical questions BEFORE studying an exhibition?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to scaffold gallery field-sketching templates and critical inquiry questions.